

Ratio-Sharp Global Defect Closure for Spherical Shells

Purely analytic support module

Abstract

This note proves the global strict proxy inequality for $0 < \rho \leq 39/50$ from the first possible radial frequency onward. It combines the exact retained-remainder identity with the ratio-dependent slope cap, a tangent minorant of the shifted sawtooth primitive, a universal ball quarter-layer, and an exact scalar convexity argument. It contains no finite Bessel-zero staircase, event-state theorem, numerical root isolation, or computer-assisted premise.

1 The global defect argument

Let

$$A_{\rho,1} := \{x \in \mathbb{R}^3 : \rho < |x| < 1\}.$$

Fix $0 < \rho < 1$ and $K > 0$. For $a > 0$, define the zero-extended ball action

$$G_a(z) := \begin{cases} \frac{1}{\pi} \left(\sqrt{a^2 - z^2} - z \arccos \frac{z}{a} \right), & 0 \leq z < a, \\ 0, & z \geq a, \end{cases} \quad (1)$$

and put

$$A(z) := G_K(z) - G_{\rho K}(z), \quad T := A(0) = \frac{(1 - \rho)K}{\pi}. \quad (2)$$

Write

$$[u]_< := \#\{n \in \mathbb{N} : n < u\}.$$

The phase reduction in the main paper supplies

$$N_D(A_{\rho,1}, K^2) \leq P(\rho, K), \quad P(\rho, K) := \sum_{\substack{\nu=\ell+1/2 < K \\ \ell \in \mathbb{N}_0}} 2\nu [A(\nu) + \tfrac{1}{4}]_<. \quad (3)$$

Indeed, the channel phase is strictly smaller than $A(\nu) + 1/4$, so at an integral proxy wall the last radial integer remains excluded. The continuous payment is

$$W(\rho, K) := \int_0^K 2zA(z) dz = \frac{2(1 - \rho^3)K^3}{9\pi}. \quad (4)$$

Action geometry and the exact defect

Differentiating (1) gives

$$q(z) := -A'(z) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{cases} \arccos \frac{z}{K} - \arccos \frac{z}{\rho K}, & 0 < z < \rho K, \\ \arccos \frac{z}{K}, & \rho K \leq z < K. \end{cases} \quad (5)$$

Thus A decreases strictly from T to 0. Let $R : [0, T] \rightarrow [0, K]$ be its decreasing inverse and set

$$F(t) := R(t)^2, \quad g(t) := -F'(t), \quad \tau := A(\rho K) = KG_1(\rho). \quad (6)$$

Write throughout

$$\theta := \arccos \rho.$$

Lemma 1 (Shape and endpoint data). *With this notation, one has*

$$0 \leq q(z) \leq \frac{\theta}{\pi}, \quad q \text{ increases on } (0, \rho K), \quad q \text{ decreases on } (\rho K, K), \quad (7)$$

and

$$g \text{ decreases on } (0, \tau), \quad g \text{ increases on } (\tau, T). \quad (8)$$

Moreover,

$$F(\tau) = \rho^2 K^2, \quad g(\tau) = \frac{2\pi\rho K}{\theta}, \quad g(T) = \frac{2\pi\rho K}{1-\rho}. \quad (9)$$

The two formulas for g agree at $t = \tau$, and $g(t) = O(t^{-1/3})$ as $t \downarrow 0$.

Proof. Direct differentiation gives

$$q'(z) = \frac{1}{\pi} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{\rho^2 K^2 - z^2}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{K^2 - z^2}} \right) > 0 \quad (0 < z < \rho K),$$

whereas

$$q'(z) = -\frac{1}{\pi\sqrt{K^2 - z^2}} < 0 \quad (\rho K < z < K).$$

Both one-sided values at $z = \rho K$ equal θ/π , proving (7).

If $z = R(t) > \rho K$, then

$$g(t) = \frac{2\pi z}{\arccos(z/K)}.$$

Its monotonicity follows from the explicit derivative

$$\frac{d}{dz} \left(\frac{z}{\arccos(z/K)} \right) = \frac{\arccos(z/K) + z/\sqrt{K^2 - z^2}}{\arccos(z/K)^2} > 0.$$

Since z decreases with t , g decreases on $(0, \tau)$. On the inner branch put

$$\delta(z) := \arccos \frac{z}{K} - \arccos \frac{z}{\rho K}.$$

The identity

$$\frac{\delta(z)}{z} = \int_{\rho}^1 \frac{ds}{s\sqrt{s^2 K^2 - z^2}}$$

has derivative

$$\frac{d}{dz} \left(\frac{\delta(z)}{z} \right) = \int_{\rho}^1 \frac{z ds}{s(s^2 K^2 - z^2)^{3/2}} > 0.$$

Hence $\delta(z)/z$ increases with z , and $g(t) = 2\pi z/\delta(z)$ increases as t increases and z decreases. The endpoint values follow by substitution and the limit $z \downarrow 0$. Finally, writing $z = K \cos u$ on the outer branch gives $t \asymp u^3$ and $g \asymp u^{-1}$. $\square$

Put

$$x_n := n - \frac{1}{4}, \quad M(r) := \#\{\ell \in \mathbb{N}_0 : \ell + \frac{1}{2} < r\}, \quad N := \#\{n \geq 1 : x_n < T\}. \quad (10)$$

For an active n , write $r_n := R(x_n)$ and $m_n := M(r_n)$.

Lemma 2 (Strict layer cake). *For every $0 < \rho < 1$ and $K > 0$,*

$$P(\rho, K) = \sum_{x_n < T} m_n^2, \quad W(\rho, K) = \int_0^T F(t) dt. \quad (11)$$

Both identities retain every radial and angular equality wall.

Proof. For a half-integer $\nu = \ell + 1/2$,

$$[A(\nu) + \frac{1}{4}]_< = \#\{n \geq 1 : x_n < A(\nu)\}.$$

Since A and R are decreasing, this is equivalent to $\nu < R(x_n)$. Interchanging the finite sums and using $\sum_{\ell=0}^{m-1} (2\ell + 1) = m^2$ proves the first identity. At $R(x_n) = m + 1/2$, strict angular counting gives $M(R(x_n)) = m$. The second identity is the area formula $\int_0^T R(t)^2 dt = \int_0^K 2zA(z)dz$. $\square$

Define

$$\mathcal{E}_{\text{ang}} := \sum_{x_n < T} (m_n^2 - r_n^2), \quad \mathcal{D}_{\text{rad}} := \int_0^T F(t) dt - \sum_{x_n < T} F(x_n). \quad (12)$$

Then

$$W - P = \mathcal{D}_{\text{rad}} - \mathcal{E}_{\text{ang}}. \quad (13)$$

The ratio-sharp angular payment

Proposition 3 (Ratio-sharp angular blocks). *For $N \geq 1$,*

$$\mathcal{E}_{\text{ang}} < \frac{(1 - \rho^2)K^2}{6} - Nd(\rho), \quad d(\rho) := \frac{3\pi}{8 \arccos \rho} - \frac{1}{4}. \quad (14)$$

The inequality is strict at every common radial-angular wall. If $N = 0$, then $\mathcal{E}_{\text{ang}} = 0$.

Proof. Fix an active n and $t \in [n - 1, x_n]$. Since $R(t) \geq r_n$,

$$x_n - t = A(r_n) - A(R(t)) = \int_{r_n}^{R(t)} q(s) ds \leq \frac{\theta}{\pi} (R(t) - r_n).$$

Integration over the left block of length $3/4$ yields

$$r_n \leq \frac{4}{3} \int_{n-1}^{x_n} R(t) dt - \frac{3\pi}{8\theta}. \quad (15)$$

Strict angular counting gives $m_n < r_n + 1/2$, including when r_n is a half-integer, and hence

$$m_n^2 - r_n^2 < r_n + \frac{1}{4} \leq \frac{4}{3} \int_{n-1}^{x_n} R(t) dt - d(\rho). \quad (16)$$

The blocks are disjoint subsets of $[0, T]$. Therefore

$$\mathcal{E}_{\text{ang}} < \frac{4}{3} \int_0^T R(t) dt - Nd(\rho).$$

The inverse area identity and scaling give

$$\int_0^T R(t) dt = \int_0^K A(z) dz = \frac{(1 - \rho^2)K^2}{8},$$

which proves (14). $\square$

The tangent-envelope radial payment

Let

$$C_0(t) := \#\{n \geq 1 : x_n < t\}, \quad w(t) := t - C_0(t), \quad \mathfrak{W}(t) := \int_0^t w(s) ds, \quad \Psi(t) := \mathfrak{W}(t) - \frac{t}{4}. \quad (17)$$

On $0 \leq t \leq 3/4$,

$$\mathfrak{W}(t) = \frac{t^2}{2}, \quad \Psi(t) = \frac{1}{2} \left(t - \frac{1}{4} \right)^2 - \frac{1}{32}. \quad (18)$$

On every later unit cell, direct integration gives

$$-\frac{1}{32} \leq \Psi(t) \leq \frac{3}{32}, \quad \mathfrak{W}(t) \geq \frac{t}{4} - \frac{1}{32}. \quad (19)$$

Lemma 4 (Retained radial remainder). *For all $0 < \rho < 1$ and $K > 0$,*

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{rad}} \geq \frac{F(\tau)}{4} - \frac{g(T)}{8} + g(\tau) \left(\frac{\tau}{4} + \frac{3}{32} \right) - \int_{(0, \tau)} \mathfrak{W}(t) dg(t). \quad (20)$$

Proof. Distributionally, $dw = dt - dC_0$. Stieltjes integration by parts gives $\mathcal{D}_{\text{rad}} = \int_0^T w(t)g(t)dt$; the improper boundary term vanishes because $\mathfrak{W}(t)g(t) = O(t^{5/3})$ at zero. On the decreasing branch,

$$\int_0^\tau wg = \mathfrak{W}(\tau)g(\tau) - \int_{(0, \tau)} \mathfrak{W} dg.$$

On the increasing branch use $w = 1/4 + \Psi'$, $\int_\tau^T g = F(\tau)$, and integrate by parts. Since $\mathfrak{W}(\tau) = \tau/4 + \Psi(\tau)$, the interface value cancels and

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{rad}} = \frac{F(\tau)}{4} + \frac{\tau g(\tau)}{4} + \Psi(T)g(T) - \int_{(\tau, T)} \Psi dg - \int_{(0, \tau)} \mathfrak{W} dg.$$

Because dg is positive on (τ, T) ,

$$\Psi(T)g(T) - \int_{(\tau, T)} \Psi dg \geq -\frac{g(T)}{8} + \frac{3g(\tau)}{32}.$$

This proves (20). Continuity of g and $\mathfrak{W}$ handles an interface on a sawtooth wall without an atom. $\square$

Define the C^1 tangent envelope

$$L_{\#}(t) := \begin{cases} t^2/2, & 0 \leq t \leq 1/4, \\ t/4 - 1/32, & t \geq 1/4, \end{cases} \quad L'_{\#}(t) = \min\{t, 1/4\}. \quad (21)$$

Equations (18)–(19) show

$$0 \leq L_{\#}(t) \leq \mathfrak{W}(t) \quad (t \geq 0). \quad (22)$$

On $1/4 \leq t \leq 3/4$ the difference is $\frac{1}{2}(t - 1/4)^2$; after $3/4$ use (19).

Assume now

$$0 < \rho \leq \frac{39}{50}, \quad K \geq \frac{\pi}{1 - \rho}. \quad (23)$$

The elementary turning estimate

$$G_1(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_s^1 \arccos u \, du \geq \frac{2\sqrt{2}}{3\pi} (1 - s)^{3/2} \quad (24)$$

is immediate: if $v = \arccos u$, then $1 - u = 1 - \cos v \leq v^2/2$, so $\arccos u \geq \sqrt{2(1 - u)}$; integration over $[s, 1]$ gives the displayed constant. It implies

$$\tau \geq \frac{2\sqrt{2}}{3} \sqrt{1 - \rho} \geq \frac{2\sqrt{2}}{3} \sqrt{\frac{11}{50}} > \frac{1}{4}.$$

The last inequality follows after squaring from $44/225 - 1/16 = 479/3600 > 0$.

On $(0, \tau)$, the measure $-dg$ is positive. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} - \int_{(0, \tau)} \mathfrak{W} \, dg &\geq - \int_{(0, \tau)} L_{\#} \, dg \\ &= -L_{\#}(\tau)g(\tau) + \int_0^{\tau} L'_{\#}(t)g(t) \, dt. \end{aligned} \quad (25)$$

There is no boundary contribution at zero. On the outer branch $t = A(z) = G_K(z)$ and $g(t)dt = -2z \, dz$, so

$$\int_0^{\tau} L'_{\#}(t)g(t) \, dt = \int_{\rho K}^K 2z \min\{G_K(z), 1/4\} \, dz. \quad (26)$$

Since $\tau > 1/4$, the interface factor becomes

$$g(\tau) \left(\frac{\tau}{4} + \frac{3}{32} - L_{\#}(\tau) \right) = \frac{g(\tau)}{8}.$$

Lemma 4 and (9) now give

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{rad}} \geq \mathcal{H}_{\#}(\rho, K), \quad (27)$$

where

$$\mathcal{H}_{\#}(\rho, K) := \frac{\rho^2 K^2}{4} - \frac{\pi \rho K}{4(1 - \rho)} + \frac{\pi \rho K}{4 \arccos \rho} + \int_{\rho K}^K 2z \min\{G_K(z), 1/4\} \, dz. \quad (28)$$

The simplified interface payment is asserted only on (23). Below $\tau = 1/4$, its unsimplified factor is $g(\tau)(\tau/4 + 3/32 - \tau^2/2)$.

The universal ball quarter-layer

Let R_B be the decreasing inverse of the restriction of G_K to $[0, K]$. Since $G_K(\rho K) = \tau > 1/4$, truncated layer cake gives

$$\frac{\rho^2 K^2}{4} + \int_{\rho K}^K 2z \min\{G_K(z), 1/4\} dz = B_0(K) := \int_0^{1/4} R_B(t)^2 dt. \quad (29)$$

Therefore

$$\mathcal{H}_\sharp(\rho, K) = B_0(K) - \frac{\pi \rho K}{4(1-\rho)} + \frac{\pi \rho K}{4 \arccos \rho}. \quad (30)$$

From (24) and $G_K(z) = KG_1(z/K)$,

$$R_B(t) \geq K - CK^{1/3}t^{2/3}, \quad C := \left(\frac{3\pi}{2\sqrt{2}}\right)^{2/3} = \frac{(3\pi)^{2/3}}{2}. \quad (31)$$

The right side is nonnegative for $0 \leq t \leq 1/4$: it is enough that $K \geq C^{3/2}/4 = 3\pi/(8\sqrt{2})$, whereas $K \geq \pi/(1-\rho) > \pi$. Squaring and integrating gives

$$B_0(K) \geq \frac{K^2}{4} - \alpha K^{4/3} + \beta K^{2/3}, \quad (32)$$

where

$$\alpha := \frac{6C}{5 \cdot 4^{5/3}}, \quad \beta := \frac{3C^2}{7 \cdot 4^{7/3}}. \quad (33)$$

Combining (13), (14), (27), and (32), and using $T \geq 1$, hence $N \geq 1$, gives

$$\begin{aligned} W - P &> \frac{1+2\rho^2}{12} K^2 - \alpha K^{4/3} + \beta K^{2/3} - \frac{\pi \rho K}{4(1-\rho)} \\ &\quad + \frac{\pi \rho K}{4 \arccos \rho} + d(\rho). \end{aligned} \quad (34)$$

Exact scalar closure

Lemma 5 (Elementary angle bound). *For $0 \leq \rho < 1$,*

$$\arccos \rho \leq \frac{\pi}{2} \sqrt{1-\rho}. \quad (35)$$

Proof. Write $\rho = \cos \theta$, $0 \leq \theta \leq \pi/2$, and $y = \theta/2$. Since $\sin y/y$ decreases on $[0, \pi/4]$,

$$\frac{\sin y}{y} \geq \frac{2\sqrt{2}}{\pi}.$$

Indeed, $(\sin y/y)' = (y \cos y - \sin y)/y^2 < 0$, because $(\sin y - y \cos y)' = y \sin y > 0$. Using $1 - \rho = 2 \sin^2 y$ gives (35). $\square$

Lemma 6 (Rational bounds for π). *One has*

$$\frac{157}{50} < \frac{333}{106} < \pi < \frac{22}{7}.$$

Proof. Put $a = \arctan(1/5)$ and $b = \arctan(1/239)$. The tangent addition formula gives

$$\tan(2a) = \frac{5}{12}, \quad \tan(4a) = \frac{120}{119}, \quad \tan(4a - b) = 1.$$

Here $b < a$, while $(6/5)^2 < 2$ gives $1/5 < \sqrt{2} - 1 = \tan(\pi/8)$, and hence $a < \pi/8$. Therefore $0 < 4a - b < \pi/2$. Thus this is Machin's identity $\pi = 16a - 4b$. The alternating arctangent expansion gives

$$a > \frac{1}{5} - \frac{1}{3 \cdot 5^3} + \frac{1}{5 \cdot 5^5} - \frac{1}{7 \cdot 5^7}, \quad b < \frac{1}{239}.$$

Indeed, these inequalities follow by integrating

$$\frac{1}{1+t^2} = 1 - t^2 + t^4 - t^6 + \frac{t^8}{1+t^2} \quad (0 \leq t \leq 1)$$

and using $1/(1+t^2) < 1$ for $t > 0$. Thus

$$\pi > \frac{1231847548}{392109375} = \frac{333}{106} + \frac{3418213}{41563593750}, \quad \frac{333}{106} - \frac{157}{50} = \frac{2}{1325} > 0.$$

For the upper bound,

$$\frac{x^4(1-x)^4}{1+x^2} = x^6 - 4x^5 + 5x^4 - 4x^2 + 4 - \frac{4}{1+x^2},$$

so integration and $4 \arctan 1 = \pi$ give

$$0 < \int_0^1 \frac{x^4(1-x)^4}{1+x^2} dx = \frac{22}{7} - \pi.$$

Also $22/7 - 333/106 = 1/742 > 0$, completing the asserted chain. $\square$

Put $e := 1 - \rho$. It suffices to prove positivity of

$$\begin{aligned} \underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K) &:= \frac{1+2\rho^2}{12} K^2 - \alpha K^{4/3} + \beta K^{2/3} - \frac{\pi \rho K}{4e} \\ &\quad + \frac{\rho K}{2\sqrt{e}} + \frac{3}{4\sqrt{e}} - \frac{1}{4}. \end{aligned} \tag{36}$$

Define

$$A := \alpha \pi^{4/3}, \quad B := \beta \pi^{2/3}, \quad C_1 := \frac{4}{3} \alpha \pi^{1/3}, \quad C_2 := \frac{2}{3} \beta \pi^{-1/3}. \tag{37}$$

Positive-side cubing and Lemma 6 give

$$A < \frac{49}{40}, \quad \frac{179}{1000} < B < \frac{1}{5}, \quad C_1 < \frac{13}{25}, \quad C_2 < \frac{1}{25}. \tag{38}$$

For completeness,

$$A^3 = \frac{3^5 \pi^6}{5^3 2^{10}}, \quad B^3 = \frac{3^7 \pi^6}{7^3 2^{20}}, \quad C_1^3 = \frac{3^2 \pi^3}{5^3 2^4}, \quad C_2^3 = \frac{3^4 \pi^3}{7^3 2^{17}}. \tag{39}$$

Thus each comparison in (38) is an exact rational cross multiplication after cubing.

Exact scalar reserve ledger. For reproducibility, the positive margins used in those cubed comparisons and in the final convexity propagation are recorded below. The first five rows are respectively the rational difference between the cube of the stated upper bound and the certified upper cube, or between the certified lower cube and the cube of the stated lower bound.

certificate	exact positive reserve
$A < 49/40$	13125773/1505907200
$B > 179/1000$	521715693010963/5619712000000000000
$B < 1/5$	176853008713/82644187136000
$C_1 < 13/25$	9767/10718750
$C_2 < 1/25$	243014341/30118144000000
turning-interface square above $1/16$	479/3600
F_0''' lower bound	676141/2450
D_0'' lower bound	1951/100
$\partial_K^2 \underline{\mathcal{G}}$ lower bound	47447/443682

Set

$$K_0 := \frac{\pi}{e}, \quad x := e^{-1/6} \geq 1. \quad (40)$$

Direct substitution gives

$$\underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K_0) = F_0(x), \quad (41)$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} F_0(x) := & \frac{\pi}{2}x^9 - Ax^8 - \frac{\pi^2}{12}x^6 + Bx^4 \\ & + \left(\frac{3}{4} - \frac{\pi}{2}\right)x^3 + \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \frac{1}{4}. \end{aligned} \quad (42)$$

The constant bounds imply

$$F_0(1) > \frac{8269}{30000} > \frac{1}{4}, \quad F_0'(1) > -\frac{14437}{6125} > -\frac{5}{2}, \quad F_0''(1) > \frac{18162}{1225} > 14. \quad (43)$$

For $x \geq 1$, group the leading terms as $x^5(252\pi x - 336A)$ and use $x^5 \geq x^3$ after the resulting coefficient is positive; indeed its rational lower bound is

$$252\frac{157}{50} - 336\frac{49}{40} = \frac{9492}{25} > 0.$$

Dropping the positive $24Bx$ term then gives

$$\begin{aligned} F_0'''(x) & > x^3 \left(252\frac{157}{50} - 336\frac{49}{40} - 10\left(\frac{22}{7}\right)^2 \right) - \frac{69}{14} \\ & \geq \frac{676141}{2450} > 0. \end{aligned} \quad (44)$$

Hence $F_0''(x) > 14$. With $y = x - 1 \geq 0$, Taylor's formula yields

$$F_0(x) > \frac{1}{4} - \frac{5}{2}y + 7y^2 = 7\left(y - \frac{5}{28}\right)^2 + \frac{3}{112} > 0. \quad (45)$$

A direct differentiation gives

$$\partial_K \underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K_0) = D_0(x), \quad (46)$$

where

$$D_0(x) := \frac{\pi}{12}(3x^6 - 5 + 4x^{-6}) + \frac{1}{2}(x^3 - x^{-3}) - C_1x^2 + C_2x^{-2}. \quad (47)$$

At $x = 1$,

$$D_0(1) > \frac{1}{300}, \quad D'_0(1) > \frac{54}{175}. \quad (48)$$

Moreover,

$$\begin{aligned} D''_0(x) &= \frac{\pi}{12}(90x^4 + 168x^{-8}) + 3x - 6x^{-5} - 2C_1 + 6C_2x^{-4} \\ &> \frac{15}{2} \frac{157}{50} - 3 - \frac{26}{25} = \frac{1951}{100} > 0. \end{aligned} \quad (49)$$

Here $x \geq 1$ gives $90x^4 \geq 90$ and $3x - 6x^{-5} \geq -3$; the omitted terms are nonnegative, and $-2C_1 > -26/25$. Thus the displayed lower bound follows term by term. Since $D''_0(x) > 0$,

$$D'_0(x) \geq D'_0(1) > 0 \quad (x \geq 1).$$

Thus D_0 is increasing and $D_0(x) \geq D_0(1) > 0$.

Finally,

$$\partial_K^2 \underline{\mathcal{G}} = \frac{1 + 2\rho^2}{6} - \frac{4\alpha}{9}K^{-2/3} - \frac{2\beta}{9}K^{-4/3}. \quad (50)$$

For $K \geq K_0 \geq \pi$,

$$\alpha K^{-2/3} \leq \frac{A}{\pi^2}, \quad \beta K^{-4/3} \leq \frac{B}{\pi^2}.$$

Consequently,

$$\partial_K^2 \underline{\mathcal{G}} > \frac{1}{6} - \frac{4(49/40) + 2(1/5)}{9(157/50)^2} = \frac{47447}{443682} > 0. \quad (51)$$

Since (51) is positive,

$$\partial_K \underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K) \geq \partial_K \underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K_0) = D_0(x) > 0 \quad (K \geq K_0).$$

Hence

$$\underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K) \geq \underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K_0) = F_0(x) > 0 \quad (K \geq K_0). \quad (52)$$

Theorem 7 (Global low- and middle-ratio proxy theorem). *For*

$$0 < \rho \leq \frac{39}{50}, \quad K \geq \frac{\pi}{1 - \rho},$$

one has

$$P(\rho, K) < W(\rho, K). \quad (53)$$

Consequently, $N_D(A_{\rho,1}, K^2) < W(\rho, K)$.

Proof. Equation (34), the angle bound, and (52) give

$$W - P > \underline{\mathcal{G}}(\rho, K) > 0.$$

The layer-cake and angular-block proofs retain every strict wall. $\square$